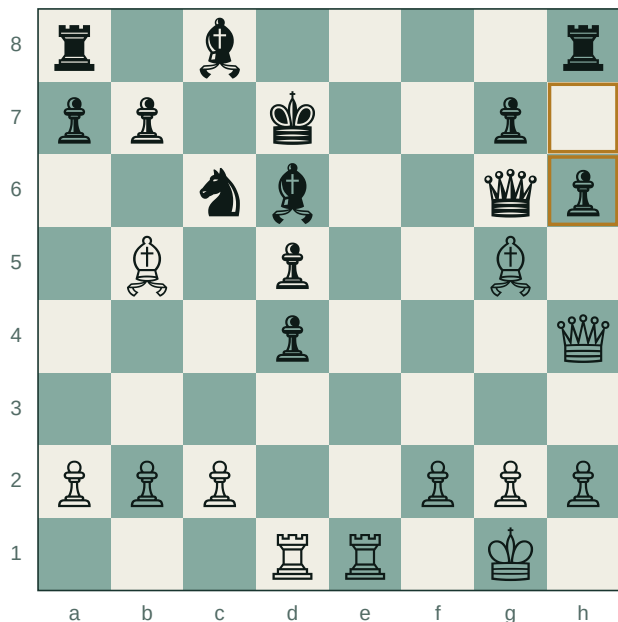


Discovered attacks: White, move 18

Discovered attacks

White to move



Previous move: 17...h6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

18. Qg4+ Kc7 19. Bd8+ Rxd8 20. Qxg6

18.Qg4+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **18...Kc7**.

19.Bd8+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. The changed line means the queen on g4 attacks the queen on g6. Recorded reply: **19...Rxd8**.

20.Qxg6 The queen captures the queen on g6.

At the end, nominal material is White 28 / Black 25 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -3 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Choose the blocker's destination carefully. An uncovered attack may fail if the opponent has a stronger check or can capture the slider.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Moving a blocker can uncover a rook, bishop, or queen attack. The moving piece may create a second threat, giving the defender too many problems at once.

HOW TO LOOK

Find a friendly piece between a slider and an enemy target, then inspect its forcing moves and captures.

The defending king is on d7. Absolute pin: knight on c6.